uxbridge

UNIAPP

Mode

Platform Mode Project Mode

Project Overview

Current Phase

Target User

Next phases

Documentation

Timeline

Transfer Assistance

← Back

Help & Feedback

Phase 2: User Research

This phase focuses on understanding the needs, context, and constraints of the target users to inform later decisions.

Related UX frameworks

Phase progress

Phase deadline date:

10 Feb 2026

0%

Research approaches for this phase

Before starting this phase, it is important to **choose a research approach**. Below, you can find a list of the most appropriate ones. Based on your context, your target and your time constraints, I highlighted the best options. You can revise or combine approaches later. Selecting an approach helps structure the next steps, not lock the project into a fixed process.

5 approaches

1. Exploratory user research

Best option

Use exploratory user research when the **problem space is still unclear**, **user needs are not well understood**, or **UX/UI considerations were not explicitly planned from the beginning.** This approach is particularly suitable at **early stages** of research-driven technological projects, or when researchers are integrating user considerations for the first time.

Related tasks:

Define your sample | Semi-structured interviews | Qualitative data analysis | Identify user needs & pain points

Apply this approach to my project

2. Mixed-methods research

Also recommended

Use mixed-methods research when **exploratory insights** need to be complemented with a **degree of validation** or comparison. This approach is appropriate when researchers must **demonstrate methodological rigor,** triangulate findings, or support decisions with **both qualitative and quantitative evidence**.

Related tasks:

Define research questions | Semi-structured interviews | Qualitative data analysis | Survey design | Quantitative data analysis | Triangulation of findings

Apply this approach to my project

3. Quantitative research

Use quantitative research when the goal is to **measure, compare, or evaluate predefined aspects of the system**, such as usability metrics, performance indicators, or preference distributions. This approach is most appropriate when the **research questions are already well defined**.

Related tasks:

Define measurable variables | Design questionnaires | Statistical analysis

Apply this approach to my project

4. Contextual inquiry

Use contextual inquiry when **understanding real-world usage, workflows, or environmental constraints** is critical. This approach is suitable when users interact with the system in **complex or situated contexts** that cannot be fully captured through interviews alone.

Related tasks:

Define observation context | Field observations | Task walkthroughs | Context documentation | Workflow mapping

Apply this approach to my project

5. Expert-based research

Use expert-based research when **direct access to end users is difficult, restricted, or ethically sensitive**. This approach is common in **early-stage research, clinical, industrial, or highly technical domains**.

Related tasks:

Identify relevant experts | Expert interviews | Assumption validation | Risk and constraint identification

Apply this approach to my project